Name_____HR_____

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8 History Unit 3: Institutions of Government STAR Cards!

QUESTION	ANSWER
3a) ☆☆☆ What are the <u>three branches</u> of government and what are their jobs?	3a) 1. **Legislative**: writes laws 2. **Executive**: enforces laws 3. **Judicial:** interprets laws
3b) ☆☆☆ What is the purpose of <u>checks and balances</u>?	3b) Checks and balances makes sure that one branch of government doesn't have all the power. Example: The president can veto laws passed by Congress.
3c) ☆☆☆ 1. What do we call the legislative branch of the Federal Government? 2. What are the <u>two parts</u>?	3c) 1. Congress 2. The Senate and the House of Representatives
3d) ☆☆☆ 1. Who is the <u>leader of the executive</u> branch of the Federal Government? 2. Who advises this leader?	3d) 1. The **President** 2. The "**Cabinet**" of advisors **who are called Secretaries** Examples: Secretary of Education, Secretary of Defense

QUESTION	ANSWER
3e)  The judicial branch is made up of many different courts. What is the <u>highest court</u> in the judicial branch?	3e) The Supreme Court
3f)  1. What are the two major political parties? 2. What are the two key differences between the parties?	3f) 1. **Democrats and Republicans** 2. **Democrats** believe the **government should have a lot of control** and should help people. **Republicans** believe the **government should have less control** and people should rely more on themselves.
3g)  Explain how <u>elections</u> work in each branch by completing this chart:	3g)

	Term Length	Term Limit	Who decides?
Representative			
Senator			
President			
Supreme Court Justice			

	Term Length	Term Limit	Who decides?
Representative	2 years	None	People in the <u>District</u> vote
Senator	6 years	None	People in the <u>State</u> vote
President	4 years	2	People in the <u>Nation</u> vote
Supreme Court Justice	For life	None	President chooses, Senate confirms